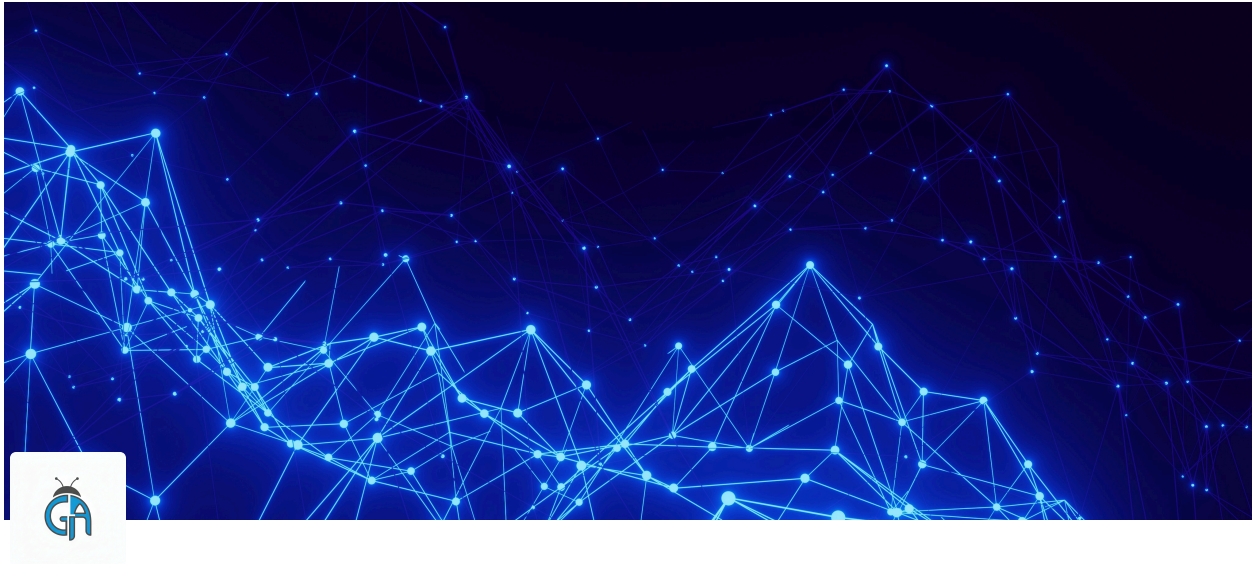




田 The Agile Testing Quadrants

The Complete Picture

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🏷️ **Tags:** QA, Agile, Strategy

🕒 **Reading Time:** 3 min

🚀 TL;DR

Testing isn't just one thing. It falls into 4 categories based on **Who** it is for and **What** tools we use.

- **Q1 (Tech):** Unit Tests.
 - **Q2 (Business):** Functional Tests.
 - **Q3 (User):** Exploratory/UAT.
 - **Q4 (Non-Functional):** Performance/Security.
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The Core Concept

We divide testing into four "Quadrants" to make sure we aren't forgetting anything.

The graph has two axes:

1. **Business vs. Technology** (Are we testing logic or code?)
 2. **Supporting the Team vs. Critiquing the Product** (Are we building it right, or breaking it?)
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The 4 Quadrants Explained

Quadrant 1: Technology-Facing / Supporting the Team

- **Focus:** Code Quality.
- **Tests:** Unit Tests, Component Tests.
- **Who:** Developers.
- **Goal:** Instant feedback. "Does this function work?"

Quadrant 2: Business-Facing / Supporting the Team

- **Focus:** Requirements.
- **Tests:** Functional Tests, User Story verification, Examples.
- **Who:** QA & Business Analysts.
- **Goal:** "Did we build what the user asked for?"

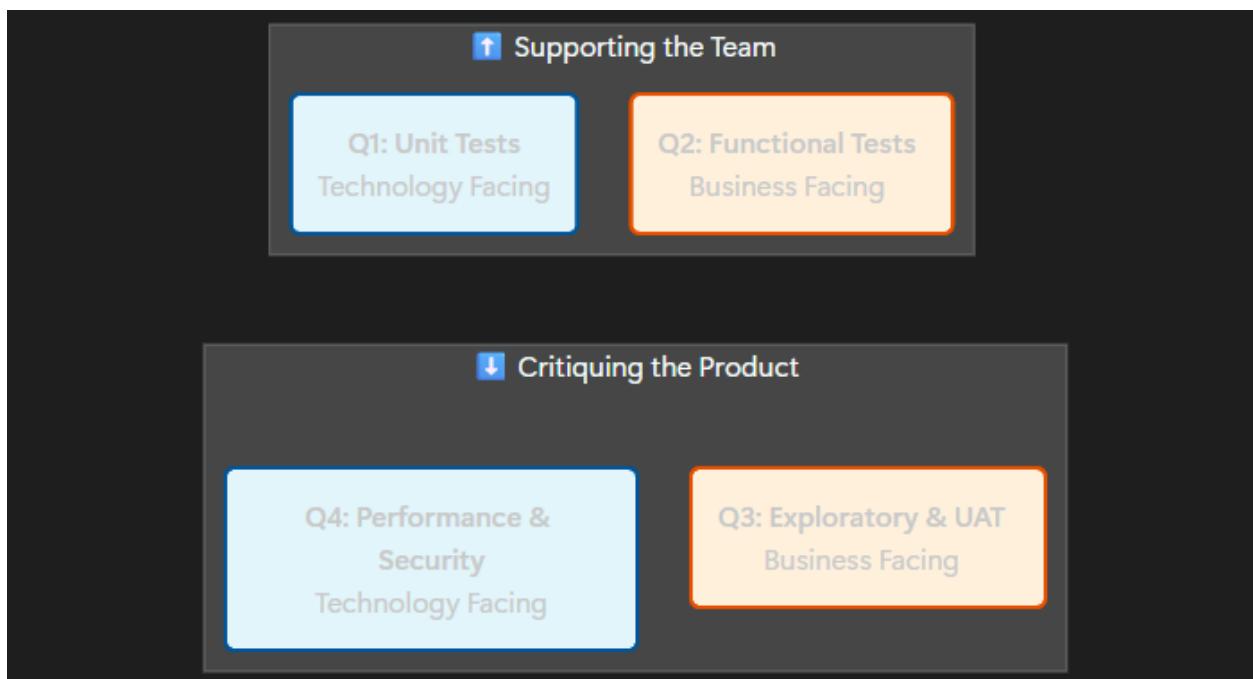
Quadrant 3: Business-Facing / Critiquing the Product

- **Focus:** Real User Experience.
- **Tests:** Exploratory Testing, Usability Testing, UAT, Alpha/Beta.
- **Who:** Manual QA & Real Users.
- **Goal:** "Is this actually easy to use? Does it make sense?"

Quadrant 4: Technology-Facing / Critiquing the Product

- **Focus:** "The 'ilities" (Stability, Scalability).
- **Tests:** Performance (Load) Testing, Security Testing.
- **Who:** SDETs / Specialized Testers.
- **Goal:** "Will it crash if 10,000 people login at once?"

The Diagram



The Car Analogy

Q1 (Tech Check):

The robot checks if the pistons fit inside the engine cylinders.

(Automated, Code level).

Q2 (Spec Check):

We check the requirements: "Does it have 4 wheels? Is it Red? Does it have leather seats?"

(Functional, Requirement level).

Q3 (Test Drive):

A driver takes it on the highway. "The steering feels a bit loose when I turn left."

(Manual, Intuition level).

Q4 (Crash Test):

We slam the car into a wall at 100mph to see if the airbags deploy.

(Specialized Tools, Stress level).

Why This Matters

Agile teams need **all four**.

If you only have Q1 and Q2, you have a product that works technically but might be terrible to use (Missing Q3).

If you ignore Q4, your app might work fine for 1 person but crash on Black Friday.

As a QA, I mostly live in **Q2** (Verifying Logic) and **Q3** (Exploratory), but I advocate for the others.